

Interactive Activity: “Scale-Up Challenge Lab”

Objective

Students will:

- Apply **growth, marketing, operations, and retention strategies**
- Make **business decisions based on scenarios**
- Present a **scaling plan for a startup**

Phase 1: Team Setup (10 mins)

Instructions

1. Form groups of **4 students**
2. Each group selects or is assigned a **business scenario**:
 - E-commerce fashion store
 - Food delivery startup
 - Fitness app
 - Online learning platform
 - Beauty/skincare brand
3. Assign roles:
 - Growth Strategist
 - Marketing Lead
 - Operations Manager
 - Customer Experience Manager

Phase 2: Scenario Brief (10 mins)

Example Scenario (provide one per group)

Your startup has gained **initial traction (1,000–5,000 users)** but growth is slowing. You must scale sustainably while maintaining quality and customer satisfaction.

Phase 3: Strategy Design Tasks (40 mins)

Each group must complete ALL 4 areas:

1. Growth Strategy (Market Expansion)

Task

Decide how your business will grow.

Guiding Questions

- Will you enter a **new market or audience segment**?
- Will you expand **products/services**?
- What is your **unique value proposition**?

Output

- ✓ 1–2 clear growth strategies
- ✓ Target market description

2. Digital Marketing Plan

Task

Design a digital marketing strategy.

Must include:

- SEO / Content strategy
- Paid ads (Google, Meta, TikTok)
- Email or automation

Guiding Questions

- Which channel gives fastest ROI?
- How will you attract vs retain users?

Output

- ✓ 3 marketing channels
- ✓ Example campaign idea

3. Operations Scaling

Task

Plan how to scale operations efficiently.

Focus Areas

- Automation (tools, AI, systems)
- Outsourcing (what and why?)
- Process improvement

Guiding Questions

- What tasks can be automated?
- What happens if demand doubles?

Output

- ✓ 2 operational improvements
- ✓ 1 automation idea

4. Customer Retention & Loyalty

Task

Turn customers into repeat buyers.

Strategies

- Loyalty programs
- Personalization
- Customer support

Guiding Questions

- Why would customers come back?
- How will you reduce churn?

Output

- ✓ 2 retention strategies
- ✓ 1 loyalty program idea

Phase 4: Pitch Presentation (20–30 mins)

Instructions

Each group presents a **5-minute pitch**:

Structure:

1. Business overview
2. Growth strategy
3. Marketing plan
4. Operations scaling
5. Retention strategy